

# Belief

Our brains can distill complex information, taking unexplainable observations and evaluating and categorizing them. From this, we form propositions—true or not—that guide us in life.

## How do our beliefs form?

Our beliefs develop out of what we hear, see, and experience, from our interactions with others and with our environment. They are entwined with our emotions, which is why an emotional response is often evoked when those beliefs are challenged. Beliefs are accepted as truth, whether there is proof or not. Our beliefs then become a filter, where information that does not support those beliefs is rejected, potentially limiting our perceptions of the world. Beliefs are not static, though—each of us has the power to choose and change our beliefs.



### Knowledge

What you know impacts on beliefs and challenges those held.



### Events

Positive and negative events both shape how you view the world.



### Future vision

How you imagine life to be is intricately linked to your beliefs.



### Environment

Where, how, and who raised you underpins many beliefs.

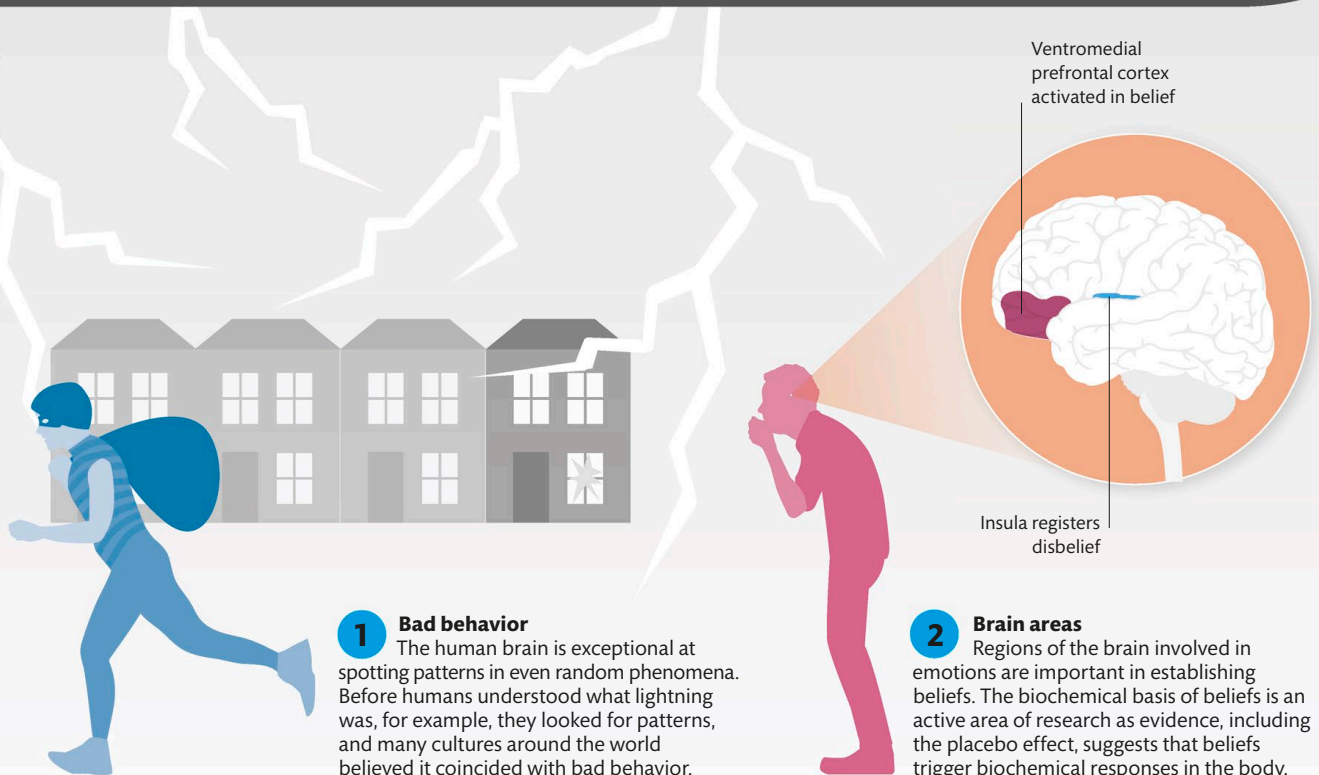
### Facets of belief

We process information from many aspects of life in order to form our beliefs. Equally, our beliefs also shape how we process this information.



### Past results

Successes and failures shape your beliefs about what is possible.



### 1 Bad behavior

The human brain is exceptional at spotting patterns in even random phenomena. Before humans understood what lightning was, for example, they looked for patterns, and many cultures around the world believed it coincided with bad behavior.

### 2 Brain areas

Regions of the brain involved in emotions are important in establishing beliefs. The biochemical basis of beliefs is an active area of research as evidence, including the placebo effect, suggests that beliefs trigger biochemical responses in the body.